USOAP CMA 2024 Protocol Questions
Aircraft accident and incident investigation — AIG

Explanatory Note on the 2024 Edition of the Protocol Questions (PQs):

Revised on the basis of the 2020 edition, this 2024 edition of the USOAP CMA Protocol Questions (PQs) follows the High-level Conference on COVID-19 (HLCC 2021) Recommendations (C-WP/15312 refers) regarding the integration of State Safety Programme Implementation Assessment (SSPIA) with traditional Universal Safety Oversight Audit Programme (USOAP) Continuous Monitoring Approach (CMA) activities that were approved by the Council of ICAO on 4 March 2022 (C-DEC 225/7 refers). Some notable features of this 2024 edition of PQs are the addition of Safety Management System (SMS) related PQs to the areas of personnel licensing and training (PEL), aircraft operations (OPS), airworthiness of aircraft (AIR), air navigation services (ANS), and aerodromes and ground aids (AGA), as well as the addition of a set of new PQs on State Safety Programme (SSP) as a new audit area.

The newly added PQs on SSP and SMS will have an undetermined status thus will not affect the Effective Implementation (EI) scores, until they are audited. Dedicated EI score for SSP will be provided separately. Once States and relevant regional organizations are migrated to the 2024 PQ edition, the EI scores for the USOAP activities on safety oversight, as indicated on the USOAP CMA online framework, will be updated and adjusted accordingly.

The existing SSPIA PQs, including the self-assessments submitted and the assessment results for those States which had received SSPIAs, will be archived and can be made available upon request.

Introduction to the ICAO USOAP CMA Protocol Questions

Protocol Questions (PQs) are the primary tool used in the ICAO Universal Safety Oversight Audit Programme (USOAP) Continuous Monitoring Approach (CMA) for assessing the effective implementation of the eight critical elements (CEs) of a State's safety oversight system. Developed based on ICAO Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs), Procedures for Air Navigation Services (PANS) and ICAO guidance material, the PQs are revised periodically by ICAO to reflect amendments to the ICAO provisions and reference documents.

The PQs are organized by audit areas and each PQ is associated with one of the eight CEs.

The nine audit areas are as follows:

1) Primary aviation legislation and specific operating regulations (LEG);
2) Civil aviation organization (ORG);
3) Personnel licensing and training (PEL);
4) Aircraft operations (OPS);
5) Airworthiness of aircraft (AIR);
6) Aircraft accident and incident investigation (AIG);
7) Air navigation services (ANS);
8) Aerodromes and ground aids (AGA); and
9) State Safety Programme (SSP).

The eight CEs are as follows:

CE-1. Primary aviation legislation
CE-2. Specific operating regulations
CE-3. State system and functions
CE-4. Qualified technical personnel
CE-5. Technical guidance, tools and provision of safety-critical information
CE-6. Licensing, certification, authorization and approval obligations
CE-7. Surveillance obligations
CE-8. Resolution of safety issues

States are expected to use the PQs to conduct regular self-assessments and in this way, monitor the health of their aviation safety oversight system in a proactive manner.

A State is deemed to have *fully addressed* a PQ when it has implemented all the required elements of the PQ. This generates a *"satisfactory"* status of implementation for the PQ. If the State provides insufficient or no evidence of compliance with the elements outlined in the PQ, the PQ is assessed as *"not satisfactory"*. The State is required to develop and implement a corrective action plan (CAP) which fully addresses the associated PQ and all identified deficiencies.

The status of each PQ for a State is reflected in the USOAP CMA Online Framework (https://www.icao.int/usoap) and summarized in the activity report.

For reference purposes, the PQs are hereby presented in a table format. Each PQ is assigned a PQ number (e.g. 1.001), associated with a CE (e.g. CE-1), and supplemented by the relevant "Guidance for Review of Evidence" and "ICAO References". PQs shown in shaded rows can be assessed only in a USOAP CMA on-site activity, while Priority PQs are indicated as such (with "Yes" note) under the "PPQ" column.

For each PQ, the corresponding "Guidance for Review of Evidence" provides *an itemized list of elements* to be implemented by the State in order to address the PQ *satisfactorily*. When preparing for a USOAP CMA audit, States should use these listed elements, as applicable, to prepare the necessary supporting documentation and evidence for all PQs within the scope of the audit. When preparing for an ICAO validation activity, States should provide the necessary supporting documentation and evidence for all PQs, within the scope of the validation activity, that were previously assessed as *"not satisfactory"*.

Representatives of a State's civil aviation authority/investigation authority who participate in USOAP CMA activities should be familiar with each PQ and the related "Guidance for Review of Evidence" that will be addressed during the activities. All the information and evidence for each PQ that are to be provided to the USOAP CMA activity team should be prepared in advance.

The "Summary of Amendments" table provides a list of new, revised, merged and deleted PQs and a brief description of the amendments.

For the 2024 edition of the PQs, the total number of PQs is 851 and a breakdown for each area is shown below:

	Area	Number of 2024 PQs
1	LEG	23
2	ORG	13
3	PEL	100
4	OPS	136
5	AIR	198
6	AIG	84
7	ANS	128
8	AGA	153
9	SSP	16
TOTAL NUMBER		***851***

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General Guidelines for All Areas

Legislation, Primary Aviation Legislation and Specific Operating Regulations

The term "legislation" in the USOAP CMA Protocol Questions is used as a generic term to include primary aviation legislation and specific operating regulations.

The term "primary aviation legislation" in the USOAP CMA Protocol Questions includes any legislative provision and/or instrument promulgated and enforceable in the State (e.g. laws, acts, codes and international treaties).

The term "specific operating regulations" in the USOAP CMA Protocol Questions includes any binding regulatory provisions and/or instruments in the State (e.g. regulations, decrees, rules, and orders).

Processes and Procedures

Processes and procedures should clarify *who does what, how, when* (or *within what timeframes*) and *in coordination with whom*, as applicable.

Delegation of Duties and Tasks

When a State has delegated some of its safety oversight duties and tasks to another State or organization, the PQs on the delegation may have to be evaluated with the entity to which the duties and tasks have been delegated.

The State remains responsible for ensuring that the delegated duties and tasks are performed, at all times, by qualified individuals who ensure the implementation of the applicable legislation as well as the established processes and procedures. There should also be a system in place for conducting surveillance of the delegated duties and tasks and a process for the resolution of identified safety deficiencies.

Regulatory Function versus Service Provider Function

For a State which has not established a clear separation between its regulatory function and its service provider function or where the State Civil Aviation Authority (CAA) is both the regulator *AND* the service provider, the related PQs remain applicable.

Industry Visits

Industry visits are conducted to review and verify that the implementation of the established requirements, procedures and safe practices in each area complies with ICAO provisions and the State's applicable national legislation.

On-Site Activity

PQs that can only be assessed in a USOAP CMA on-site activity are shown in shaded rows in the PQ table.

Priority Protocol Questions (PPQs)

A subset of PQs is classified as Priority PQs or PPQs, which, if found not satisfactory, may indicate a lack of capability by a State to identify and/or resolve operational safety and fundamental accident investigation deficiencies effectively.

Annex

The term "Annex" in the USOAP CMA Protocol Questions stands for Annex to the Chicago Convention.

ICAO References

The ICAO references are classified as follows (shown here in alphabetical order): Chicago Convention (CC), ICAO Circular (Cir), ICAO Guidance Material (GM), Procedures for Air Navigation Services (PANS), Recommended Practice (RP), Regional Supplementary Procedures (SUPPS), and Standard (STD).

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Specific Guidelines for AIG

The AIG PQs are primarily related to the aircraft accident and incident investigation system established by the State and are applicable whether or not the State has established a permanent investigation authority.

The term "accident investigation authority" is used, in a generic sense, to refer to the authority, permanent or ad hoc, that is in charge of aircraft accident and incident investigations.

For PQs associated with CE-5, *Technical guidance, tools and provision of safety-critical information*, review of the policies/procedures and guidance material on the notification and investigation of aircraft accidents and incidents should address not only the availability/establishment of these policies/procedures and guidance material to the relevant staff, but also their implementation. These PQs will be marked "*not satisfactory*" if:

a) there are no written documents (e.g. procedures, guidelines and checklists); or
b) the existing documents are not satisfactory (e.g. they do not comply with the requirements of the relevant ICAO reference documents); or
c) the existing documents, albeit satisfactory, are not systematically followed when the situation described in the PQ arises.

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Acronyms and Abbreviations

A = Annex to the Chicago Convention
ADREP = Accident/Incident Data Reporting
AIG = Aircraft Accident and Incident Investigation
Amdt. = Amendment
App. = Appendix
ATS = Air Traffic Services
Att. = Attachment to an ICAO document
C = Chapter
CAA = Civil Aviation Authority
CC = Chicago Convention
CE = Critical Element
Cir = ICAO Circular
CMA = Continuous Monitoring Approach
CVR = Cockpit Voice Recorder
Doc = ICAO Document or Manual
ECCAIRS = European Co-ordination Centre for Aviation Incident Reporting Systems
GM = ICAO Guidance Material
IIC = Investigator-in-Charge
MoU = Memorandum of Understanding
OJT = On-the-job Training
PPQ = Priority Protocol Question
PQ = Protocol Question
RAIO = Regional Accident and Incident Investigation Organization
RP = Recommended Practice contained in an Annex to the Chicago Convention
SAAQ = State Aviation Activity Questionnaire
STD = International Standard contained in an Annex to the Chicago Convention
USOAP = Universal Safety Oversight Audit Programme

List of ICAO Reference Documents

Doc 7300 — *Convention on International Civil Aviation* (also known as the Chicago Convention)
Annex 9 — *Facilitation* (16th edition, July 2022)
Annex 13 — *Aircraft Accident and Incident Investigation* (13th edition, July 2024)
Annex 19 — *Safety Management* (Amdt. 1, 2nd edition, July 2016)
Doc 9683 — *Human Factors Training Manual* (1st edition, 1998)
Doc 9734 — *Safety Oversight Manual*
Part A — *The Establishment and Management of a State's Safety Oversight System* (3rd edition, 2017)
Doc 9735 — *Universal Safety Oversight Audit Programme Continuous Monitoring Manual* (5th edition, 2023)
Doc 9756 — *Manual of Aircraft Accident and Incident Investigation*
Part I — *Organization and Planning* (Amdt. 1, 2nd edition, 2015)
Part II — *Procedures and Checklists* (1st edition, 2012)
Part III — *Investigation* (1st edition, 2011)
Part IV — *Reporting* (3rd edition, 2020)
Doc 9946 — *Manual on Regional Accident and Incident Investigation Organization* (1st edition, 2011)
Doc 9962 — *Manual on Accident and Incident Investigation Policies and Procedures* (2nd edition, 2019)
Doc 9973 — *Manual on Assistance to Aircraft Accident Victims and their Families* (1st edition, 2013)
Doc 9998 — *ICAO Policy on Assistance to Aircraft Accident Victims and their Families* (1st edition, 2013)
Doc 10053 - *Manual on Protection of Safety Information*
Part I – *Protection of Accident and Incident Investigation Records* (1st edition 2016)
Doc 10151 - *Manual on Human Performance (HP) for Regulators* (1st edition, 2021)
Doc 10206 - *Manual on Aircraft Accident and Incident Investigation Training* (First edition, 2024)
Cir 315-AN/179 — *Hazards at Aircraft Accident Sites* (2008)

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SUMMARY OF AMENDMENTS – AIG PQs

Note 1.— The PQs are listed here sequentially for convenience. This may differ from their order on the USOAP CMA Online Framework or in the following document.
Note 2.— The PQs in the shaded rows require a USOAP CMA on-site activity. For the remaining PQs, no on-site activity is required in most cases.

PQ No. (2020 version)	PQ No. (2024 version)	Type of Amendment					Description of Amendments
		New	Revised	Deleted	Merged	No change	
6.001	6.001					✓	No change.
6.003	6.003		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.004	6.004					✓	No change.
6.006	6.006		✓				Question revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.007	6.007					✓	No change.
6.010	6.010					✓	No change.
6.011	6.011					✓	No change.
6.015	6.015					✓	No change.
6.017	6.017					✓	No change.
6.021	6.021					✓	No change.
6.023	6.023					✓	No change.
6.025	6.025					✓	No change.
6.027	6.027					✓	No change.
6.029	6.029		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.031	6.031		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised
6.033	6.033					✓	No change.
6.035	6.035					✓	No change.
6.101	6.101		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.103	6.103					✓	No change.
6.105	6.105					✓	No change.
6.111	6.111					✓	No change.
6.113	6.113					✓	No change.
6.117	6.117					✓	No change.

PQ No. (2020 version)	PQ No. (2024 version)	Type of Amendment					Description of Amendments
		New	Revised	Deleted	Merged	No change	
6.119	6.119		✓				Reference revised.
6.121	6.121					✓	No change.
6.123	6.123		✓				Reference revised.
6.125	6.125		✓				Reference revised.
6.129	6.129		✓				Reference revised.
6.133	6.133		✓				Reference revised.
6.135	6.135					✓	No change.
6.201	6.201					✓	No change.
6.202	6.202		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.205	6.205		✓				Reference revised.
6.209	6.209		✓				Reference revised.
6.210	6.210					✓	No change.
6.211	6.211					✓	No change.
6.303	6.303					✓	No change.
6.311	6.311					✓	No change.
6.315	6.315					✓	No change.
6.316	6.316					✓	No change.
6.317	6.317					✓	No change.
6.319	6.319		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.321	6.321					✓	No change.
6.323	6.323					✓	No change.
6.325	6.325					✓	No change.
6.327	6.327					✓	No change.
6.329	6.329		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.341	6.341					✓	No change.
6.343	6.343		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity
6.345	6.345					✓	No change.
6.347	6.347					✓	No change.
6.349	6.349					✓	No change.

PQ No. (2020 version)	PQ No. (2024 version)	Type of Amendment					Description of Amendments
		New	Revised	Deleted	Merged	No change	
6.353	6.353					✓	No change.
6.359	6.359					✓	No change.
6.361	6.361					✓	No change.
6.367	6.367					✓	No change.
6.371	6.371		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.373	6.373					✓	No change.
6.375	6.375					✓	No change.
6.377	6.377					✓	No change.
6.379	6.379					✓	No change.
6.380	6.380		✓				Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.381	6.381		✓				Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.383	6.383		✓				Reference revised.
6.391	6.391					✓	No change.
6.395	6.395		✓				Guidance revised for clarity.
6.397	6.397					✓	No change.
6.401	6.401		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity. .
6.403	6.403		✓				Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.405	6.405					✓	No change.
6.407	6.407		✓			~~✓~~	~~No change.~~Guidance revised for clarity. Revision 2.
6.409	6.409					✓	No change.
6.411	6.411					✓	No change.
6.413	6.413		✓				Reference revised.
6.417	6.417		✓				Reference revised.
6.421	6.421					✓	No change.
6.425	6.425		✓				Reference revised.
6.427	6.427					✓	No change.
6.429	6.429		✓				Reference revised.
6.431	6.431		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.433	6.433		✓				Question revised for clarity. Guidance revised for clarity. Reference revised.

PQ No. (2020 version)	PQ No. (2024 version)	Type of Amendment					Description of Amendments
		New	Revised	Deleted	Merged	No change	
6.501	6.501		✓				Question revised for clarity. Reference revised.
6.507	6.507					✓	No change.
6.511	6.511					✓	No change.

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PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
6.001	Has the State promulgated legislation requiring the institution of an investigation for aircraft accidents and serious incidents in compliance with the provisions of Annex 13?	1) Title and content of the legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations). 2) Date of promulgation and last amendment.	STD A13 5.1 & 5.1.2 GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2, 2.1.1	Yes	CE-2
6.003	Does the State's primary legislation provide for the establishment of an independent accident investigation authority and contain all necessary provisions to ensure the independence of said authority?	1) Verify that the State's primary legislation contains the necessary provisions to ensure the establishment of the accident investigation authority as well as its organizational and operational independence from any outside influences, including those from judicial authorities and civil aviation authorities. 2) Verify in particular the existence of provisions requiring that the accident investigation authority: a) shall not receive nor seek instructions in the conduct of the investigation; and b) have unrestricted access to and control over the information related to its investigations. Note to the auditor: When a State delegates the conduct of all investigations under its responsibility to another State or an RAIO, that State would still need to have an accident investigation authority established, in accordance with Standard 3.2 of Annex 13.	STD A13 3.2 & 5.4 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.1	Yes	CE-1
6.004	Does the State's primary legislation clearly delegate authority to the	Verify the authority delegated to the Head of the accident investigation	GM Doc 9734		CE-1

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	Head of the accident investigation authority to institute aircraft accident and serious incident investigations?	authority in the State's primary legislation.	Part A, C3		
6.006	Has the State transposed the provisions of Annex 13 into its legal framework?	1) Verify that provisions in regulations are effected in a timely manner to reflect the latest amendments to Annex 13. 2) Confirm that the differences between SARPs and the State legislation and practices are identified and notified to ICAO using the Compliance Checklist/Electronic Filing of Differences (CC/EFOD) system. Note to the auditor: States may also notify differences to ICAO using other means.	CC Arts. 12, 37 and 38 STD A19 3.2.1 & 3.2.2 GM Doc 9734 Part A, C2	Yes	CE-2
6.007	Has the State promulgated legislation requiring immediate notification of aircraft accidents and serious incidents within the State to the accident investigation authority?	1) Verify that the legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations) provides sufficient details on the type of incidents that are or may be serious incidents and that need to be immediately notified to the investigation authority. 2) Verify that the legislation requires the notification to be made as soon as possible and by the quickest means available. 3) Confirm that notifications are submitted, in a timely manner, either to the investigation authority, when there is a permanent one, or to the designated authority in the other cases.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 4.2.1	Yes	CE-2
6.010	Has the State established the means to make aircraft accident	Review the means available to access the regulations and supplementary	GM Doc 9734		CE-2

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	and incident investigation enabling regulations and directives, orders, circulars, publications, etc., readily available to the public?	regulatory instruments (i.e. Official Gazette; internet, government printing office). Note to the auditor: The publication of the legislation is addressed in LEG PQ 1.011.	Part A, C3		
6.011	Has the State promulgated legislation stipulating that accident prevention is the sole objective of aircraft accident and serious incident investigations and that it is not the purpose of the investigation to apportion blame or liability?	Review legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations).	STD A13 3.1 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.2.1		CE-2
6.015	Has the State implemented procedures for the amendment of its accident and serious incident investigation enabling regulations and national standards?	1) Verify documented evidence of procedures implemented for the amendment of regulations. 2) Verify that amendments are effected in a timely manner as needed when an amendment to Annex 13 is received. 3) Verify evidence of the review made and action taken by the State after receipt of the last amendments to Annex 13. 4) The development of amendment procedures is addressed in LEG PQ 1.009.	CC Art. 37 GM Doc 9734 Part A, C3		CE-2
6.017	Has the State implemented a procedure for identifying and notifying differences, if any, to ICAO?	1) Verify documented evidence of the procedure and effective implementation. 2) Verify the review made and action taken by the State after receipt of the last amendments to Annex 13. Note to the auditor: The development of such procedure is	CC Arts. 37 & 38 GM Doc 9734 Part A, C3		CE-2

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		addressed in LEG PQ 1.025.			
6.021	Does the State's primary legislation grant the accident investigation authority/investigator in charge (IIC) unhampered access to and control over the scene of the accident in order, for example, to protect the aircraft or wreckage as well as the accident site against access by unauthorized persons, pilfering or deterioration?	1) Review primary legislation. 2) Verify the particular situation in the State regarding judicial investigations, and the impact on the capacity of the State to comply with Annex 13.	STD A13 3.2, 5.4 & 5.6 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.2.1, 5.1 & 5.3	Yes	CE-1
6.023	Does the State's primary legislation grant the accident investigation authority/IIC unhampered access to and control over all relevant material/evidence, including flight recorders and air traffic service (ATS) records?	1) Review primary legislation. 2) Verify the particular situation in the State regarding judicial investigations and the impact on the ability of the State to comply with Annex 13.	STD A13 5.4 & 5.6		CE-1
6.025	Does the State's primary legislation enable the accident investigation authority/IIC to carry out detailed examination of relevant material/evidence without delay?	1) Review primary legislation. 2) Verify the particular situation in the State regarding judicial investigations, and the impact on the ability of the State to comply with Annex 13.	STD A13 5.4 & 5.6		CE-1
6.027	Does the State's primary legislation enable the accident investigation authority/IIC to conduct interviews with witnesses and others who can contribute to the investigation?	Review primary legislation.	STD A13 5.4		CE-1
6.029	Does the State's primary legislation contain provisions to ensure the non-disclosure of CVR recordings and airborne image recordings to the public?	1) Review primary legislation. 2) Verify the effectiveness of the means in place to achieve the prevention of disclosure of recordings, such as: a) national laws, regulations, and policies; b) authoritative safeguards such as protective orders, closed proceedings or	STD A13 5.12.5 & App. 2, 2.3 GM Doc 10053 Part I, 3.6	Yes	CE-1

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		in-camera review; or c) technical means such as encrypting or overwriting, before returning the cockpit voice recorders or airborne image recorders to the owners.			
6.031	Does the State's primary legislation contain provisions to ensure the protection of accident and incident investigation records?	1) Review primary legislation. 2) Verify the particular situation in the State regarding judicial investigations, and its impact on the ability of the State to comply with Annex 13. 3) Verify the existence of a competent authority able to administer a balancing test to determine whether the disclosure or use of accident and incident investigation records outweighs the likely adverse domestic and international impact such action may have on that or any future investigations. 4) Records in the custody or control of the accident investigation authority that are to be protected include: a) cockpit voice recordings and airborne image recordings and any transcripts from such recordings; b) records from interviews with persons by the investigation authorities in the course of the investigation; c) communications between persons having been involved in the operation of the aircraft; d) medical or private information regarding persons involved in the accident or incident; e) recordings and transcripts of recordings from air traffic control units;	STD A13 5.12, 5.12.1 & App. 2 GM Doc 10053 Part I, C3	Yes	CE-1

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		f) analysis of and opinions about information (including flight recorder information) made by the accident investigation authority and accredited representatives in relation to the accident or incident; and g) the draft final report of an accident or incident investigation.			
6.033	Has the State promulgated legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations) permitting, as the State conducting the investigation, the participation of accredited representatives from other States involved?	1) Review legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations). 2) Verify the particular situation in the State regarding judicial investigations, and its impact on the capacity of the State to comply with Annex 13. 3) Confirm that the participation of accredited representatives from the following States is permitted: a) State of Registry; b) State of Operator; c) State of Design; d) State of Manufacture; and e) any other State which, on request, provides information, facilities or experts. 4) The entitlement must include the following: a) visit the scene of the accident; b) examine the wreckage; c) obtain witness information and suggest areas of questioning; d) have full access to all relevant evidence as soon as possible; e) receive copies of all pertinent documents; f) participate in read-outs of recorded media;	STD A13 5.18, 5.23 & 5.25 GM Doc 9756 Part II, 3.5 & C5		CE-2

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		g) participate in off-scene investigative activities, such as component examinations, technical briefings, tests and simulations; h) participate in investigation progress meetings, including deliberations related to analyses, findings, causes, contributing factors and safety recommendations; and i) make submissions of the various elements of the investigation.			
6.035	Has the State promulgated legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations) to require the re-opening of an investigation if new and significant evidence becomes available?	Verify legislation (primary aviation legislation or regulations).	STD A13 5.13		CE-2
6.101	Has the State established an investigation authority with a clear and documented structure and in a manner that ensures independence from State aviation authorities and other entities that could interfere with the conduct or objectivity of an investigation?	1) Review the details of the organizational structure established (which may be permanent or ad hoc) and the related functions and responsibilities. 2) Verify that the authority is clearly independent from State aviation authorities and other entities that could interfere with the conduct or objectivity of an investigation, and in particular: a) the functional independence from the ministry which oversees the State civil aviation authority; b) if the investigation is autonomous; c) the unrestricted authority to publish information like interim statements, safety recommendations and the final report; and d) the independent funding and staffing. 3) Verify that it clearly indicates the line	STD A13 3.2 GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2 Doc 9962	Yes	CE-3

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		of responsibility. 4) Take note of names and acronyms of the established authorities and each section dealing with accident and serious incident investigation activities. 5) Cross-check State Aviation Activity Questionnaire (SAAQ).			
6.103	If the investigation authority has regional offices, is there an effective system in place for coordination and standardization?	1) Review coordination process/procedures and sample activities (e.g. regular meetings, training). 2) Method of communication in both directions.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2		CE-3
6.105	Has the State established and implemented a process to ensure that the accident investigation authority has sufficient financial resources to investigate accidents and serious incidents?	1) Review process. 2) Review whether the funding is commensurate with the policy in place on how (to what depth and scope) accidents and serious incidents will be investigated. 3) Verify that the process includes supplementary funding of accident investigations when required (major accidents). Note to the auditor: The State may decide to delegate some or all investigations to other States or to regional organizations.	STD A13 Att. F GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.3		CE-3
6.111	Does the State have appropriately qualified personnel identified and charged with aircraft accident and serious incident investigation duties?	1) Review list and qualifications of the designated personnel (including full-time and part-time/seconded investigators). 2) Ensure that the qualifications of the personnel are appropriate for the assigned duties and responsibilities. 3) Ensure that the qualifications include sufficient practical experience, and not only theoretical knowledge acquired in	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2		CE-3

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		courses or seminars.			
6.113	Has the State implemented a mechanism to ensure that the accident investigation authority has sufficient personnel to meet its national and international obligations related to aircraft accident investigations?	1) Review methodology to identify staffing needs for the various investigation related activities, including those related to notifications, first actions after an accident or serious incident, organization and conduct of the investigation, and report development. 2) Verify the actual number of aircraft accident investigators employed or available and number of investigations conducted under the State's responsibility. 3) Review process to establish and fill the required posts initially and on an on-going basis. 4) Review State's ability to accomplish all required activities including: a) development of regulations, procedures and other guidance material; b) training; and c) reporting and analyses of safety deficiencies. 5) If the State does not have its own appropriately qualified personnel, or not in sufficient numbers, verify the existence of arrangements with other States or with regional organizations (i.e. Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)). Such arrangements should be sufficient to ensure that the State would obtain the necessary personnel in an expeditious manner in the event of an accident or serious incident.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2 Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 C4	Yes	CE-3
6.117	Have job descriptions been	1) Review job descriptions for all	GM		CE-3

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	developed for the personnel in charge of investigation-related duties?	personnel in charge of investigation-related duties. 2) In the case of ad hoc investigation commissions, review description of functions established for the chairperson and other members of the commission.	Doc 9734 Part A, C3		
6.119	Has the State/investigation authority: 1) established appropriate minimum qualifications and experience requirements for aircraft accident investigators; and 2) ensured that the established minimum qualifications and experience requirements are met by all its investigators?	1) Review required qualifications for the recruitment of investigators (in the case of full-time investigators) or for the designation of investigators (in the case of "occasional investigators"). 2) Requirements should include: a) knowledge and practical experience in civil aviation (as pilot, engineer, air traffic controller or other areas of expertise); and b) in the case of occasional investigators, investigation courses and practical experience in investigations. 3) Sample recruitment files and verify the actual qualifications and experience of recruited investigators.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2 Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 C4 Doc 10206 C1		CE-4
6.121	Has the State/investigation authority: a) issued credentials to its investigators, and b) established formal means (such as letters of agreement), to clarify the entitlements and obligations of each individual participating in the investigation?	1) Verify legislation/regulations/policy on the issuance of investigators credentials. 2) Review credentials issued to investigators, including full-time and part-time investigators to ensure inclusion of: a) Reference to empowering legislation/regulation; b) Method to control currency of credentials; and c) Photo of investigator. 3) Verify the existence of standardized templates to be used to issue credentials, written agreements or other documents	STD A13 5.25 GM Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 4.2.2 & 4.2.5		CE-3

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		to the various participants (i.e. seconded experts, accredited representatives, advisers, observers and experts).			
6.123	Has the State/investigation authority developed a formal training programme detailing the type of training to be provided to its investigators?	1) Review contents of training programme. 2) Include initial, OJT, recurrent and specialized training, including timetables, as applicable. 3) Verify in particular the inclusion of initial and recurrent training regarding safety at the accident site.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2 Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 4.3 Doc 10206		CE-4
6.125	Has the investigation authority: 1) developed periodic training plans detailing and prioritizing the type of training to be provided during the established period; and 2) appropriately implemented the training programme?	1) Review most recent training plan to ensure that: a) it contains the type and frequency of training provided (initial, OJT, recurrent and specialized); and b) type and frequency of training are sufficient for the technical personnel to acquire/maintain the required level of knowledge, skills, competence and qualifications in accordance with their assigned duties and responsibilities. 2) Verify that the investigation authority provides investigators with initial and recurrent training related to safety at the accident site.	GM Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 4.3.2 & App. E Doc 10206 Cir 315	Yes	CE-4
6.129	Has investigation authority established and implemented a system for the maintenance of training records for its technical personnel, including records on the OJT received?	1) Review written instruction, procedure and/or requirement for the establishment and maintenance of training records. 2) Verify that training records are systematically retained and comprise not only certificates of attendance but also information on the course content. 3) Verify that the training records on the	Doc 9962 4.3.4 Doc 10206		CE-4

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		OJT provided include details on the training activities performed (e.g. participation as an observer or performance of tasks under supervision) and their outcome. 4) If there are no records or insufficient records on OJT, this question should be "not satisfactory" (N/S).			
6.133	If the State has arrangements to use experts seconded by the State's CAA or other organizations in the State as investigators, has it established and implemented measures to relieve these experts from their regular duties during the investigation?	1) Review that the applicable arrangements ensure the release of the experts for the whole duration necessary, which, for some experts, may include specific periods beyond the initial phase of the investigation (e.g. for the analysis of the information collected or for the investigation report development). 2) Review that the arrangements ensure that the experts are relieved from their normal duties as necessary during their secondment to the investigation.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.5.1		CE-3
6.135	If the State uses experts seconded by the State's CAA or other organizations in the State as investigators, has it established and implemented measures to avoid possible conflicts of interest?	1) Review applicable arrangements or procedures. 2) Ensure that the procedures include an assessment of potential conflict of interest of proposed experts before their actual secondment to an investigation.	GM Doc 9756 Part I Doc 9962 4.2.5		CE-3
6.201	Does the State provide its investigators with all necessary investigation and protective equipment as well as all the necessary means of communications and transportation to enable the conduct of investigations?	1) Review investigators' equipment available (e.g. tools, survey equipment, marking equipment, protective equipment, etc.) and guidance material/procedures issued. 2) Ensure that the equipment is available in sufficient quantity for all personnel who may need to access the accident site.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2, 2.5, C5, 5.4, 5.8 & App. 1 Doc 9734 Part A, C3 Doc 9962 4.4 & 4.5 Cir 315	Yes	CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		3) Ensure that the protective equipment is adapted to the local conditions in the State. 4) Verify that the State/the investigation authority keeps a list of the collective and individual equipment available and keeps this list up-to-date. 5) Verify that the relevant personnel is aware of and has ready access to the equipment.6) Review means of communications and transportation available.			
6.202	Are appropriate facilities and office equipment available to the entity in charge of aircraft accident and incident investigations?	1) Assess adequacy of facilities for the investigators and other personnel involved in investigation tasks. 2) Verify the availability of: a) telephones/cell phones; b) printer; c) photocopier; d) computer/laptops/notebooks; e) Internet/Intranet.	GM Doc 9734 Part A, C3		CE-5
6.205	Has the investigation authority developed and implemented guidelines to ensure that its investigators have their investigation field kits, protective equipment and essential personal items packed and ready to proceed without delay to the accident site?	1) Review guidance material. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.6		CE-5
6.209	Has the investigation authority established and implemented means to ensure that its investigators are provided with the necessary, up-to-date documentation to effectively	Sample and review the available documentation, including ICAO documentation, applicable manufacturers' documents, and the necessary procedures and checklists.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.7.1.1, 2.7.2 & App. 8		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	accomplish their functions and responsibilities?				
6.210	Has the investigation authority established and implemented means to ensure the proper maintenance of aircraft accident and serious incident investigation files?	1) Review established means. 2) Sample and review investigation files for investigations which the State has conducted and participated in.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 5.7.3.4 Part II, App. 6, Appendix 2 to Section 1, Item 7, "Documentation"; Part II, App. 6, Section 5, "AT THE CONCLUSION OF THE FIELD PHASE" & "POST-FIELD PHASE" & Appendix 1 to Section 5 Part IV, 1.1.3. Doc 9962 10.2.1		CE-5
6.211	Has the State established and implemented arrangements and/or procedures to ensure the availability of hangars/storage facilities when needed in order to protect the evidence and maintain safe custody of the aircraft for such a period as may be necessary for the purposes of the investigation?	1) Verify existing arrangements and/or procedures and evidence of effectiveness. 2) Verify arrangements and procedures to ensure protection against fire and unauthorized access. 3) Verify the availability of hangars/storage facilities.	STD A13 3.2		CE-5
6.303	Has the investigation authority developed and issued an investigation procedures manual or equivalent guidance material, containing the policies and procedures to be followed for investigation related tasks?	1) Review procedures manual or equivalent guidance material issued (e.g. manual, handbook or any other set of controlled documents). 2) Ensure that the manual is customized as needed to reflect the system in place. 3) Verify that the investigation manual addresses all relevant aspects of the conduct of aircraft accident and serious incident investigations by the State and	RP A13 5.4.2 GM Doc 9756 Part I, C3 Part II, 4.7, 4.8, C5 & Apps. Doc 9962		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		the participation of the State in aircraft accident and serious incident investigations conducted by other States. 4) Verify if there is a process to manage amendments and that investigators are actually using the latest amendments.			
6.311	Does the State have means in place to ensure that correct and up-to-date contact information of aircraft accident investigation authorities of other States is made available to, and used by the personnel in charge of forwarding accident or incident initial notifications to other States?	1) Verify the accuracy of the contact information made available to the relevant personnel. 2) Verify that amendments are made based on the contact list published on the ICAO public website.	STD A13 4.1 GM Doc 9962 C5		CE-5
6.315	Has the State established and implemented a system to ensure that: 1) notifications of accidents and incidents (forwarded within the State or forwarded by other States) are received and processed without delay during office hours as well as out-of-office hours; and 2) the contact details for the notification to the investigation authority have been made publicly available and notified to ICAO?	1) Verify the process to report occurrences on a 24-hour basis. 2) Verify that the duty officer system is operational on a 24-hour basis. 3) Review how the duty officer's contact number has been made available in the State. 4) Check the State's contact information published on the ICAO public website.	STD A13 4.1 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 4.2 Doc 9962 C5 ICAO Public Website		CE-5
6.316	Has the State established procedures and guidance, including a checklist, for the initial response following the receipt of a notification?	Verify that a checklist has been established and implemented for the initial actions to be taken by the duty officer after receipt of a notification.	STD A13 4.6, 4.7, 4.10, 4.11 & corresponding notes RP A13 4.5 & 4.9		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
			GM Doc 9756 Part I, 4.7 Doc 9962 5.4		
6.317	Has the State, as State of Occurrence, established and implemented procedures to ensure the forwarding of accident/incident notifications to other States involved and, when applicable, ICAO?	Review procedures and recent notifications (in particular notifications transmitted to ICAO).	STD A13 4.1 & 4.4 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 4.3 Doc 9962 C5		CE-5
6.319	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure the forwarding of accident/incident notifications to the States involved and, when applicable, ICAO in the following situations where it is not the State of Occurrence: • as State of Registry, in the case of an occurrence in a non-Contracting State or outside the territory of any State? • as State of Registry or State of the Operator, when the State of Occurrence is not aware of an incident?	1) Review procedures. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	STD A13 4.1 & 4.8 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 4.3.3 Doc 9962 C5		CE-5
6.321	Are initial notifications of aircraft accidents and incidents forwarded with a minimum of delay and by the most suitable and quickest means available to the States concerned and ICAO, when applicable?	1) Review copies of recent notifications and date of dispatch. 2) Verify that the State has not unnecessarily delayed the forwarding of initial notifications while waiting to compile additional information.	STD A13 4.1 & 4.2		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
6.323	Is the format and content of the notification clear and concise, prepared in one of the ICAO working languages, taking into account the language of the recipient(s), and does it contain all available information?	1) Review the means established (e.g. template) to ensure that the notifications sent systematically adhere to the required format. 2) Review copies of recent notifications.	STD A13 4.2 & 4.3		CE-5
6.325	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure that it informs the State conducting the investigation if it intends to appoint an accredited representative and, if so, provides the associated details?	1) Review procedures. 2) Verify that the procedures require the State to appoint an accredited representative when specifically requested to do so by the State conducting an investigation (for an accident to an aircraft of a maximum mass of over 2 250 kg). 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available, such as copies of relevant correspondence.	STD A13 4.6 & 4.10 GM Doc 9756 Part II, 3.5		CE-5
6.327	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure that it provides the State conducting the investigation with, as applicable, any relevant information regarding the aircraft and flight crew involved in an aircraft accident or serious incident as soon as possible?	1) Review procedures. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	STD A13 4.6 & 4.10 GM Doc 9962 5.4.3		CE-5
6.329	Has the State, as the State of the Operator, established and implemented procedures to ensure that it provides the State conducting the investigation with the details of dangerous goods on board the aircraft with a minimum of delay and by the most	1) Review procedures. 2) Ensure that the process and guidance material established are sufficiently detailed and are customized to the system in place, in particular, that it includes the means to contact concerned operators to obtain the information. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective	STD A13 4.7 & 4.11 GM Doc 9962 5.4.3		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	suitable and quickest means available?	implementation, if available, such as copies of relevant correspondence providing the State conducting the investigation with the details of dangerous goods on board the aircraft.			
6.341	Has the State adopted the definitions listed in Chapter 1 of Annex 13?	1) Review legislation, regulations or guidance material. 2) Ensure that the legislation and/or regulations include definitions of the terms used therein when these terms are defined in Annex 13. 3) Verify, in particular, that the State has adopted the definitions for “accident”, “incident”, “serious incident”, “investigator-in-charge” and “accredited representative” contained in Annex 13.	STD A13 C1		CE-5
6.343	Has the State established and implemented policies and procedures to ensure that the accident investigations it conducts include the gathering, recording and analysis of all relevant information to enable the issuance of safety recommendations and the determination of causes and/or contributing factors?	1) Review policies, procedures and guidance material established. 2) Ensure that the policies, procedures and guidance material established are sufficiently detailed, are customized to the system in place and help determine the extent of an accident investigation (including the scope of the investigation and whether or not investigators will be deployed on site), depending on the circumstances of the accident and the safety lessons expected to be drawn from the investigation. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	STD A13 5.1 & 5.4 RP A13 5.4.2 GM Doc 9756 Part I, 2.6, 3.1 & 3.2 Part II, 1.1.3, 2.2.3 & C4 Doc 9962	Yes	CE-5
6.345	Has the State established and implemented: a) a process for investigating serious incidents; and	1) Review the established process (including procedures and guidelines) to help determine which types of incidents (in particular, ATS-related incidents) will	STD A13 5.1.2 RP	Yes	CE-5

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	b) a process, based on risk analysis, to help determine which types of incidents will be investigated by the investigation authority, in conformance with Annex 13?	be investigated by the investigation authority, in conformance with Annex 13. 2) Verify that the above process is based on risk analysis. 3) Ensure that the procedures and guidelines established are sufficiently detailed and are customized to the system in place. 4) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	A13 5.1.1 & 5.4.2 GM A13 Att. C Doc 9756 Part I, 2.6, 3.1 & 3.2 Part II, 2.2.2, 2.3 & C5 Doc 9962		
6.347	Has the investigation authority established and implemented procedures to ensure that it informs the aviation security authorities immediately if an act of unlawful interference was involved or is suspected?	1) Review procedures. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if there were such occurrences.	STD A13 5.11 GM Doc 9962 6.1.7		CE-5
6.349	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure the immediate initiation of an investigation through the designation of an experienced investigator as investigator-in-charge (IIC) and the appointment of an investigation team, as necessary?	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Sample list of assigned investigators and review qualifications and experience. 3) In the case of ad hoc investigation commissions, review not only the qualifications and experience of the chairperson and other members of the commission, but also those of the investigators sent to the accident site and/or in charge of investigation groups.	STD A13 5.5 GM Doc 9756 Part I, C2 Part II, 3.2 Doc 9962 6.1.5	Yes	CE-5
6.353	Has the State established and implemented guidance material, including a checklist, to ensure: a) that all air traffic services (ATS) communication recordings and documents associated with the flight are secured and placed in safe keeping as soon as possible,	1) Review guidance material issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	STD A13 3.2 RP A13 5.8 Note GM Doc 9756	Yes	CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	and b) the preservation of all evidence of a transitory nature of the wreckage through photography or other appropriate means?		Part I, 3.5, 5.1 & 5.3 Part II, 5.3.2 & App. 6, Section 21 Doc 9962 C6 & 7.1.2		
6.359	Has the State established and implemented means to ensure: a) the cooperation between the accident investigation authority and the judicial authorities, so that an investigation is not impeded by administrative or judicial investigations or proceedings; and b) separation between the investigation conducted under Annex 13 and the one by the judicial authority?	Review effective implementation of legislation/regulations and/or formal arrangements, if any. Examples: Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs) related to coordination of activities related to: access to the site of the accident; preservation of and access to the evidence; identification of victims; flight recorder read-outs, examinations of relevant material/evidence; initial and ongoing debriefings of the status of each process; exchange of information; appropriate use of safety information; and resolution of conflicts.	STD A13 5.4.1 & 5.10 RP A13 5.4.3 & 5.4.4 GM Doc 9756 Part I,2.6.1, 3.3.5 & App. 5 to C2	Yes	CE-2
6.361	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure the timely recovery and effective read-out of the flight recorders in compliance with Attachment D to Annex 13?	1) Verify procedures for recovery and handling of recorders, including damaged recorders and recorders recovered from water. 2) Verify that the recovery and/or read-out are not impeded or delayed for: a) administrative reasons (e.g. senior management or IIC may feel that it is necessary for the IIC to be present at all investigative activities and therefore delay recorder read-out until on-site documentation is complete); b) judicial reasons (apprehensions about chain of custody or the need to delay	STD A13 5.7 GM A13 Att. D Doc 9962 6.1.8 Doc 9756 Part I, 5.6 & App. 2 to C5 Part II, App. 6, Section 10	Yes	CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		readout until judicial authorities determine their role and plan); or c) financial reasons (inability of staff to initiate readout without high level travel or funding approval). 3) For underwater recovery, verify that the State has established and implemented a clear plan for initiating, funding, and overseeing underwater recovery and how these aspects will be conducted. 4) Verify that the procedures cover not only the choice of the read-out facility, but also the mode of participation of the State of Design/Manufacture and the State of the Operator in the flight recorder read-out and analysis activities.			
6.367	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, promulgated regulations or established and implemented guidance material to ensure that it allows advisers assisting accredited representatives to participate in an investigation to the extent necessary to make the representatives' participation effective?	1) Review regulations/guidance material. 2) Verify that invitations include: a) the air operator, when neither the State of Registry nor the State of the Operator appoints an accredited representative; and b) the organizations responsible for the type design and the final assembly of the aircraft, when neither the State of Design nor the State of Manufacture appoints accredited representatives. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation when applicable.	RP A13 5.19, 5.20, 5.21 & 5.24		CE-5
6.371	Has the State promulgated regulations to entitle the participation of experts of States which have special interest in an accident by virtue of fatalities or	1) Verify regulations. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available. 3) States which have special interest in an accident by virtue of fatalities or serious	STD A13 5.27		CE-2

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	serious injuries to its citizens in accordance with Annex 13?	injuries to its citizens should be entitled to: a) Visit the scene of the accident; b) Have access to the relevant factual information which is approved for public release; and c) Receive a copy of the final report.			
6.373	Has the investigation authority established and implemented procedures and guidance material for the protection of investigators against biological hazards and other hazards at the accident site?	1) Review procedures and guidance material. 2) Ensure that the guidance material has been customized as needed to reflect the local conditions and the safety equipment available. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 5.4, 5.5 & App. 1, C5 Part II, App. 6, Section 4 Doc 9962 4.5 Cir 315		CE-5
6.375	Has the State established and implemented guidance material to ensure that, when needed, autopsy examinations are carried out?	1) Review guidance material issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available. 3) Review arrangements, if any.	STD A13 5.9 GM Doc 8984 Part IV, 1.5 to 1.7 Doc 9756 Part I, 2.6.1 & Apps. 6 & 8 to C2 Part II, App. 6, Section 8		CE-5
6.377	Has the State established and implemented guidance material to ensure that, when needed, expeditious medical examination of the flight crew, passengers and involved aviation personnel is conducted by a physician, preferably experienced in accident investigation?	1) Review guidance material issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	RP A13 5.9.1 GM Doc 8984 Part IV, 1.10 Doc 9756 Part I, 2.6.1 & App. 8 to C2		CE-5
6.379	Has the State established and	1) Review guidance material for carrying	GM		CE-5

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	implemented guidance material to ensure that, when needed, examination or testing of aircraft parts or components will be carried out in a thorough manner?	out or supervising examinations and tests. 2) Verify that the guidance material has been customized as needed to reflect the system in place and in particular the available facilities. 3) Verify that the guidance material includes guidance on the duties of the investigation authority for the preparation, conduct and follow up of the examinations and tests.	Doc 9756 Part I, 5.7 Doc 9962 C9		
6.380	Has the State established and implemented guidance material to ensure that operational, human factor and organizational aspects are investigated in a thorough manner, as needed?	1) Review guidance material and its implementation 2) Verify that the guidance material describes how to investigate: a) human performance (physical, physiological and psychological factors); b) latent (unsafe) conditions in organizations or in the regulatory framework; and c) systemic issues that could contribute to accidents or incidents. 3) Review if the final reports of recent investigations include the analysis of operational, human factor and organizational aspects.	GM Doc 9756 Part I, 3.2 & Part III, C3 and C16 Doc 9683 C4 Doc 9962 C8 Doc 10151		CE-5
6.381	Has the investigation authority established and implemented procedures to ensure that relevant and timely information on the progress of the investigation will be provided to the families and accident survivors?	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	AR A39-27 STD A13 5.27 RP A13 5.28 GM		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
			Doc 9962 8.5 Doc 9973 Doc 9998		
6.383	Has the State established a comprehensive system for providing assistance to aircraft accident victims and their families?	Verify that: 1) the primary aviation legislation, specific operating regulations and/or policies establish family assistance plans that address the scope, responsibilities, roles and coordination necessary to provide assistance to aircraft accident victims and their families; 2) the State has ensured that air operators and aerodrome operators have established family assistance plans; 3) the family assistance plans are periodically reviewed by the State and service providers; 4) the State has ensured that air operators have arrangements with aerodromes in which they operate to implement the family assistance plans; and 5) an agency is designated to coordinate the timely and appropriate delivery of assistance. Note to the auditor: This PQ is linked to PQs 6.371 and 6.381.	STD A9 8.42, 8.43, 8.45, 8.46 and 8.47 RP A9 8.44 & 8.48 GM Doc 9973 Doc 9998		CE-3
6.391	Has the State, as a State participating in an aircraft accident or serious incident investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that it provides the State conducting an	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, when applicable. 3) The information and elements required are: a) in all cases, all relevant information	STD A13 5.14 to 5.17 GM Doc 9962 5.4		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	investigation with all the information and elements required throughout the investigation process?	requested by that State; b) in all cases, information on an aircraft which prior to the occurrence of an accident or incident has used or normally would use the State's facilities or services; c) as State of Registry or State of the Operator, flight recorder records or the associated flight recorders when an aircraft involved in an accident or serious incident lands in a State other than the State of Occurrence; and d) as State of Registry or State of the Operator, information on organizations whose activities may have directly or indirectly influenced the operation of the aircraft.			
6.395	Has the State, as a State participating in an aircraft accident or serious incident investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that it appoints advisers proposed, as applicable, by the operator or by the organizations responsible for the type design and the final assembly of the aircraft?	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	STD A13 5.19 & 5.20 GM Doc 9962 5.4		CE-5
6.397	Has the State, as a State having suffered fatalities or serious injuries to its citizens, established and implemented procedures to send an expert to the State of Occurrence?	1) Review procedures issued (to address where the expert will come from, by whom he/she will be accompanied, with what mandate and guidance, etc.). 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation, if available.	STD A13 5.27		CE-5
6.401	Has the State promulgated legislation requiring that all final	1) Review legislation. 2) Review means for making final reports	STD A13	Yes	CE-2

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	reports from aircraft accidents and serious incidents investigations be completed and made publicly available?	publicly available, such as a public website.	5.4 & 6.5		
6.403	Has the State established and implemented guidelines regarding the development, content and format of the final report?	1) Review guidelines. 2) Review final report(s). 3) Verify that final reports comprise the following main headings: a) factual information; b) analysis; c) conclusions, including causes and/or contributing factors; and d) safety recommendations, as appropriate.	RP A13 6.1 & App. 1 to A13 GM Doc 9756 Part II, 4.6.5 & 4.6.6 Part IV, 1.3 & Apps. 1 to 5 to C1 Doc 9962 10.4		CE-5
6.405	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that the final report is completed as soon as possible and that, if the report is not made available within 12 months, an interim statement is made publicly available on each anniversary of the occurrence, detailing the progress of the investigation and any safety issues raised?	1) Review procedures. 2) Verify if there is a time frame for the release of the final report. 3) Verify if target dates are met. 4) Verify if there is a monitoring system to ensure that target dates are met. 5) Verify if there are indications on possible elements to be included in the interim statements, depending on the progress of the investigation. 6) Verify that interim statements are effectively made available when needed.	STD A13 6.5 & 6.6 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, 1.5.1 Doc 9962 10.7.1 & 10.7.4	Yes	CE-5
6.407	Has the State established and implemented procedures to ensure the consultation on the draft final report with all States which participated in the investigation, inviting their substantiated comments on the report within sixty days from the date of the	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation. 3) Verify that the State forwards the draft final report to all accredited representatives. 4) Verify that the response time allowed by the State is at least ~~60 days.~~30 days	STD A13 6.3 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, 1.4 Doc 9962 10.5		CE-5

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	transmittal letter?	and that this time is extended to 60 days if additional time is requested by the State invited to comment.			
6.409	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that a copy of the draft final report is sent for comments: a) through the State of the Operator to the air operator; and b) through the State of Design and State of Manufacture to the organizations responsible for the type design and the final assembly of the aircraft?	1) Review procedures. 2) If no, verify that there is a procedure to ensure that: a) a copy of the draft final report is sent to the air operator/the organizations responsible for the type design and the final assembly of the aircraft; and b) the associated States are informed of the transmission of the draft final report to the operator/the organization responsible for the type design and the final assembly of the aircraft. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	RP A13 6.3.1 & 6.3.2 GM Doc 9962 10.5.2		CE-5
6.411	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that it will either amend the draft final report to include the substance of the comments received or, if desired by the State which provided the comments, append the comments to the final report?	1) Review procedures issued. 2) Ensure that the procedures address in sufficient detail the analysis of comments recorded and the subsequent decision-making process. 3) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	STD A13 6.3 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, 1.4.3 Doc 9962 10.5.3		CE-5
6.413	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that it sends the final report to ICAO, as applicable, and to all States involved, including any State having suffered fatalities or serious	1) Review procedures. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation and practices.	STD A13 6.4 & 6.7 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, 1.5.4 & 1.7.1 Doc 9962 10.6 & 10.7		CE-5

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	injuries to its citizens and any State which provided relevant information, significant facilities or experts?				
6.417	Has the State, when issuing or receiving a draft final report, established and implemented measures to ensure that it is not disclosed to the public?	1) Review the measures established. 2) Review evidence to ensure that draft final reports are not disclosed and any documents obtained during an investigation of another State are prevented from circulation, publication, or giving unauthorized access without the express consent of the State which conducted the investigation, unless such reports or documents have already been published or released by that latter State.	STD A13 5.12.6 & 6.2 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, 1.4.3		CE-5
6.421	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented guidelines regarding the development and issuance of safety recommendations, at any stage of an accident or incident investigation, to the appropriate authorities, including those in other States(s) concerned and, when ICAO documents are involved, to ICAO?	1) Review guidelines. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation and, in particular, that safety recommendations issued (if any) were correctly and clearly worded and were addressed to appropriate authority(ies) and ICAO, when applicable.	STD A13 6.8 & 8.3 GM Doc 9756 Part II, 4.6.2 to 4.6.4 Part IV, App. 1 to C1, 4 & App. 6 to C1 Doc 9962 10.8.1	Yes	CE-8
6.425	Has the State, as the State receiving safety recommendations from other States, established and implemented procedures: a) to monitor the progress of any action taken in response to these safety recommendations, and b) to ensure that it informs the	1) Review procedures and mechanism established. 2) Review correspondence sent/received. Note to auditor: Safety recommendations may result from diverse sources, including safety studies.	STD A13 6.10 & 6.12 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, App. 6 to C1 Doc 9962 10.8.2.1	Yes	CE-8

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
	proposing State within 90 days of the preventive action taken or under consideration or the reasons why no action will be taken?				
6.427	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, established and implemented procedures to ensure that intended safety recommendations are included in the draft final report forwarded to the States and organizations concerned?	1) Review procedures. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation.	STD A13 6.3, Note 4 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, C1 Doc 9962 10.4.4		CE-8
6.429	Has the State developed and implemented procedures to record responses to the safety recommendations it has issued?	1) Review procedures and mechanism established. 2) Review correspondence sent/received.	STD A13 6.11 GM Doc 9962 10.8.2.2		CE-8
6.431	Has the State, as the State conducting the investigation, developed and implemented procedures to ensure that it sends ADREP data reports to ICAO?	1) Review procedures. 2) Review copies of submitted reports and distribution list. 3) Ensure that the procedures provide for the forwarding of ADREP data reports to ICAO when the aircraft involved in an accident is of a maximum mass of over 2 250 kg.	STD A13 C7 GM Doc 9756 Part IV, C3 & App.1 to C3 Doc 9962 C11		CE-8
6.433	Are ADREP data reports sent to ICAO with the complete information required for accident prevention and in a format compatible with the ADREP taxonomy?	1) Review copies of submitted ADREP data reports. 2) Review if ADREP data reports include the following recommended fields in a format compatible with the ADREP taxonomy: a) occurrence class (accident, serious incident, incident…); b) local date;	GM Doc 9756 Part IV, C3 & App. 1 to C3		CE-8

PQ No.	Protocol Question	Guidance for Review of Evidence	ICAO References	PPQ	CE
		c) State/area of occurrence; d) aircraft manufacturer/model; e) flight phase; f) occurrence category; and g) event type coding.			
6.501	Has the State established and implemented (through the necessary legislation, procedures and guidance to the industry) a mandatory safety reporting system to facilitate the collection of information on actual or potential safety deficiencies?	1) Review applicable legislation, regulations, procedures and mechanism established. 2) Review evidence to confirm effective implementation and, in particular, that the number of reports received is commensurate with the level of aviation activity in the State. 3) Coordinate the assessment with team members in all other areas of the activity.	STD A19 5.1.2 GM Doc 9859 5.2.5 Doc 9962 C12	Yes	CE-8
6.507	Has the State established an accident and incident database, in a standardized format, to facilitate the effective analysis of information on actual or potential safety deficiencies and to determine any preventive actions required?	1) Review database established. 2) Review the stored data. 3) Review the database format. 4) Verify if the taxonomy is compatible with ADREP/European Co-ordination Centre for Aviation Incident Reporting Systems (ECCAIRS).	STD A13 8.1 GM Doc 9962 12.1.2 & 12.1.3	Yes	CE-8
6.511	Does the State analyze the information contained in its accident/incident reports and database to determine any required preventive action?	1) Review access of applicable State authorities. 2) Review relevant data/information. 3) Verify if the data are being analysed.	STD A13 8.1	Yes	CE-8

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